CODE MODE

Claude Code added an experimental Code Mode

> Codex's changelog has listed it since at least July 8. Anthropic's post on code execution with MCP explains the general idea.

READ ON

THE GENERAL IDEA

Direct tool calls versus the model writing code

Anthropic's post describes direct tool calling: definitions loaded upfront, every intermediate result passing through the model. Its alternative is to present MCP servers as code APIs and let the agent write code.

EXHIBIT 02 VERYDIAN

DIRECT CALLS

- TOOL DEFS UPFRONT
- RESULTS VIA MODEL

VS

CODE APPROACH

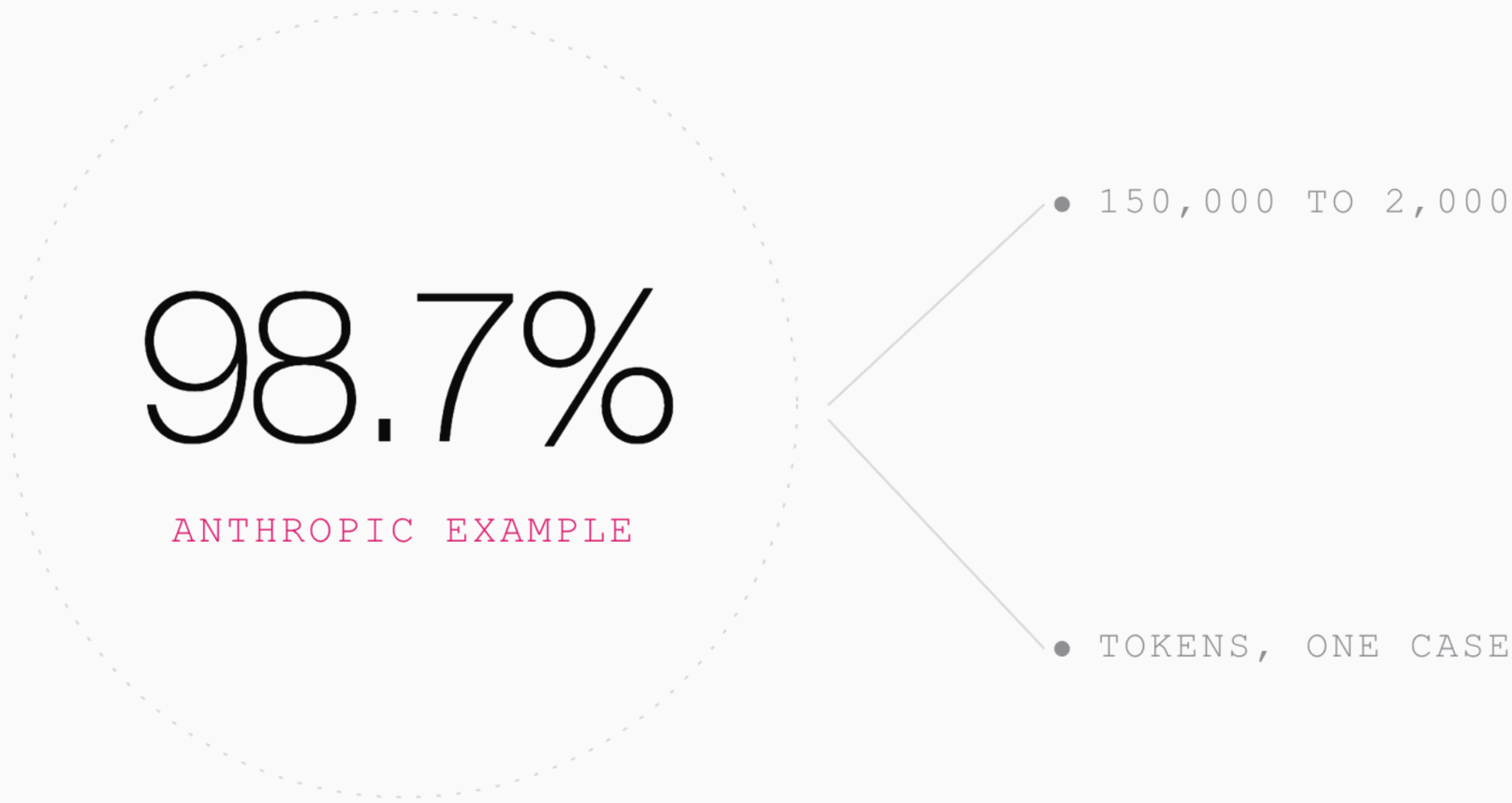
- TOOLS AS CODE APIS
- MODEL WRITES CODE

ONE VENDOR EXAMPLE

Anthropic's worked example: 150,000 tokens down to 2,000

One example from Anthropic's Nov 4, 2025 post on MCP code execution in general. It calls the drop a saving of 98.7%. It does not benchmark either product.

EXHIBIT 03 VERYDIAN



DATED CHANGELOG LINES

Codex since at least July 8. Claude Code since November 12.

Codex's page mentions it from 0.143.0 on July 8, then JavaScript helpers on October 8 and interrupts on October 15. Claude Code: November 12, an experimental opt-in.

EXHIBIT 04 VERYDIAN

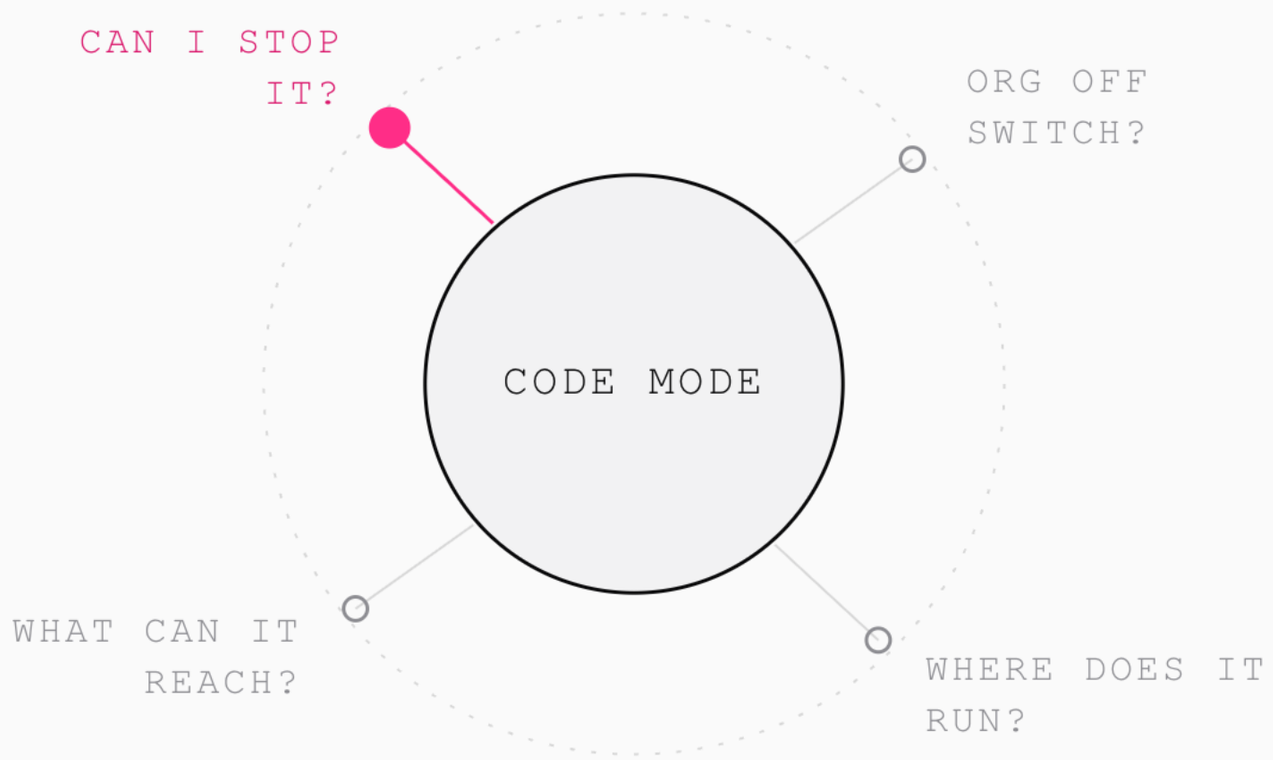


QUESTIONS, NOT CLAIMS

Four questions before you turn it on

Codex 0.163.0 says interrupting a turn stops active Code Mode cells.
Claude Code's changelog mentions turning it off for an organization.
For where it runs and what it reaches, I have no primary answer.

EXHIBIT 05 VERYDIAN

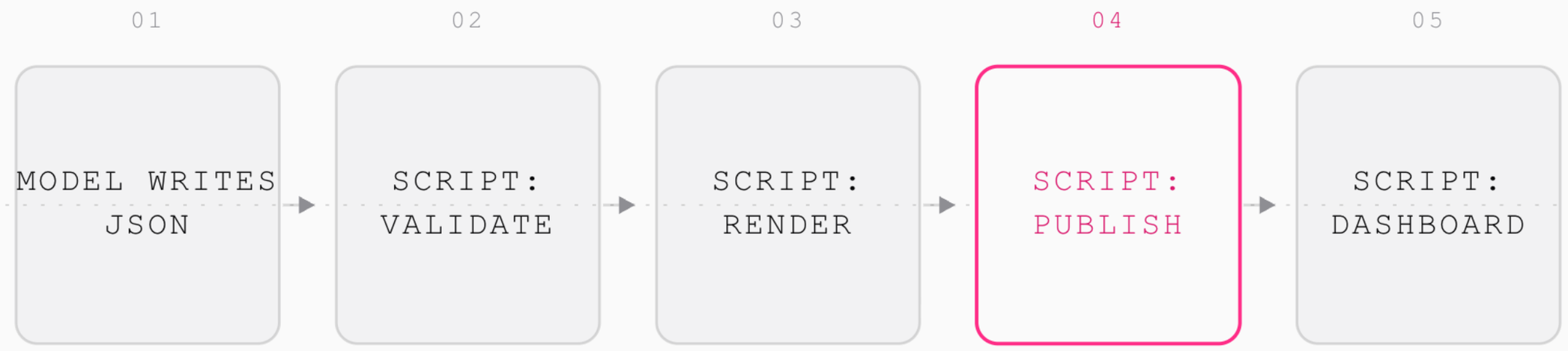


BY HAND TODAY

My pipeline already hands data between scripts

The model writes the three JSON files. Validate, render, publish and dashboard are scripts, so the slide data moves on to Notion and Buffer without being pasted back through a model.

EXHIBIT 06 VERYDIAN





Run it on one low-stakes task first

I haven't tried it in either tool, so treat these as questions, not findings.

TEST ON ONE TASK